

CMS TEAM in Pennsylvania: 26 Hospitals Across 13 Core-Based Statistical Areas (CBSAs), and Why Pennsylvania's TEAM Mandate Looks Nothing Like New York's

Jennifer Tim-Diamond for Rainfall Health

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Draft briefing ported from the Rainfall TEAM website guide and wired to the live CMS TEAM roster in this repo. Hospital counts and figures 1–2 recompute on render. Episode-dollar models are not invented here.



White paper

CMS TEAM in Pennsylvania: 26 Hospitals Across 13 Core-Based Statistical Areas (CBSAs), and Why Pennsylvania's TEAM Mandate Looks Nothing Like New York's

26 mandated hospitals · 13 CBSAs · before PY2 (2027) Jennifer Tim-Diamond for Rainfall Health · September 2026
Pennsylvania has 26 mandated hospitals across 13 CBSAs — the most geographically dispersed TEAM state roster in the country. UPMC, Penn State Health, and Geisinger anchor a market where most hospitals are outside the Philadelphia and Pittsburgh metros.



WHITE PAPER

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Draft TEAM briefing · live roster counts

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01 • At a glance

Live hospital counts come from data/territoryHospitals.json (March 2026 CMS TEAM participant extract). Editorial context (Medicare population, HRRP, LEJR) is carried from the published Rainfall guide and is **not** recomputed from claims.

Table 1

Signal	Value	Why it matters
Mandated hospitals	26	Multi-system Mid-Atlantic roster
CBSAs	13	Largest CBSA: Harrisburg–Carlisle (5 hospitals)
Medicare beneficiaries	See state guide	Covered-lives scale
HRRP	Cited in state guide (CMS HRRP)	Readmission pressure under episode accountability
Est. annual LEJR	See state guide	Volume concentration

02 • Where the mandate sits

Largest market in this scope: **Harrisburg–Carlisle** (5 hospitals).

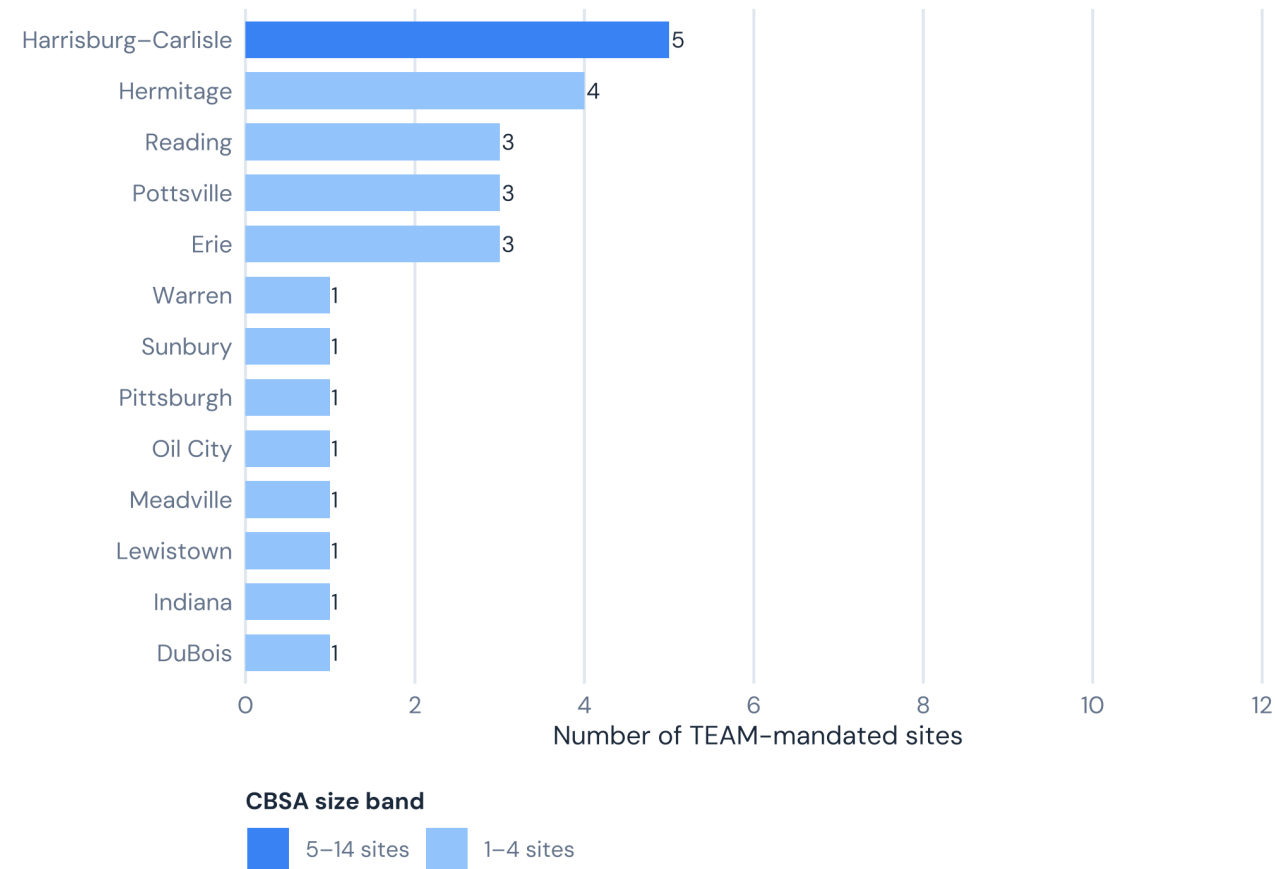
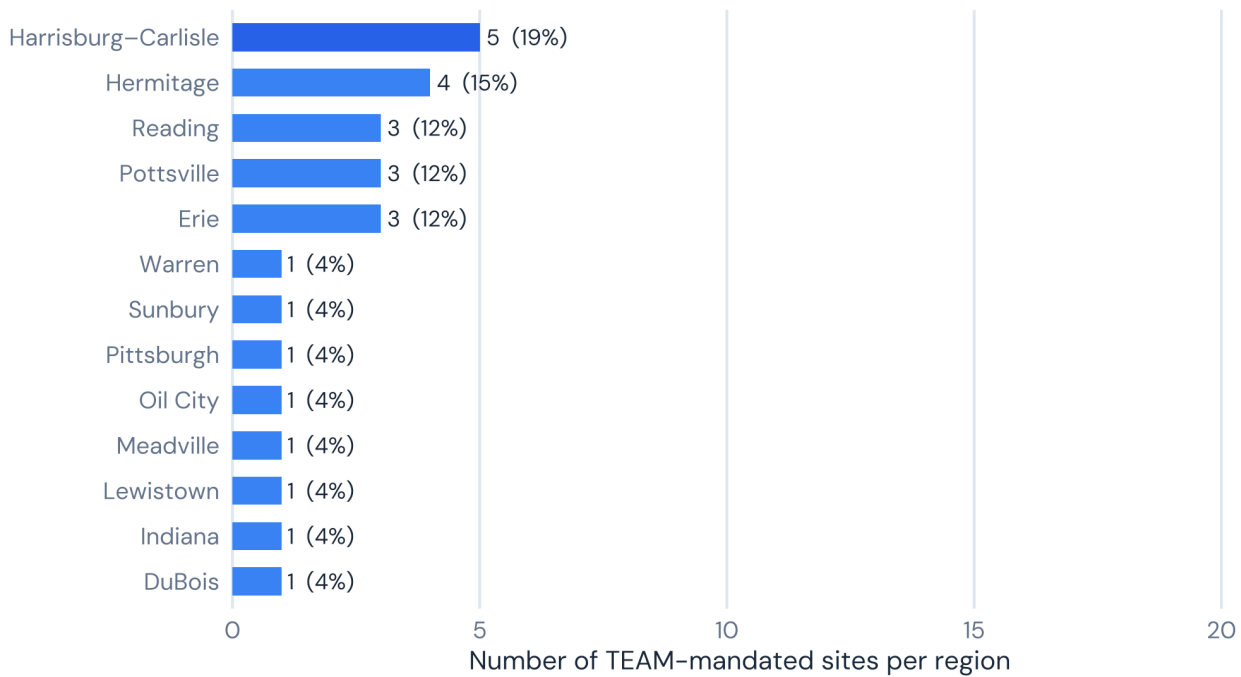


Figure 1: CMS TEAM-mandated hospitals in this scope.



Table 2

CBSA	Hospitals	Share (%)
Harrisburg–Carlisle	5	19.2
Hermitage	4	15.4
Erie	3	11.5
Pottsville	3	11.5
Reading	3	11.5
DuBois	1	3.8
Indiana	1	3.8
Lewistown	1	3.8
Meadville	1	3.8
Oil City	1	3.8
Pittsburgh	1	3.8
Sunbury	1	3.8
Warren	1	3.8



Market concentration



Figure 2: Concentration of TEAM-mandated hospitals.

03 · Guide narrative (from the website TEAM report)

Takeaways

- 26 hospitals across 13 CBSAs
- Harrisburg leads: UPMC and Penn State Health
- Philadelphia and Pittsburgh largely excluded
- 51% HRRP rate: above national average
- Geisinger across multiple CBSAs

Pennsylvania’s TEAM mandate: 13 CBSAs and the absence of Pittsburgh and Philadelphia

Pennsylvania’s CMS TEAM mandate is the most geographically fragmented of any top-10 TEAM state. With **26 hospitals across 13 CBSAs**, each CBSA contains an average of only two mandated hospitals — compared to New York’s 65 hospitals in a single metro CBSA. This dispersion reflects a counterintuitive feature of CMS’s CBSA selection methodology: the CMS algorithm selected markets based on regional surgical episode volume patterns, and Pennsylvania’s selection concentrated on smaller regional cities and county-seat markets rather than its two largest metropolitan areas.

The striking absence of **Philadelphia** and **Pittsburgh** from the TEAM mandate is the defining structural feature of Pennsylvania’s cohort. The Philadelphia–Camden–Wilmington CBSA — home to Penn Medicine (Penn Presbyterian, Penn Medicine Chester County, Jefferson Health), Temple University Health, Main Line Health, and others — was not selected as a TEAM market. The Pittsburgh CBSA — UPMC’s flagship territory — similarly was not selected. This means that UPMC, one of the most frequently cited organizations in value-based care discussions, participates in TEAM **not** through its Pittsburgh flagship but through its secondary market hospitals in Harrisburg, Hermitage, Erie, and other western Pennsylvania locations.

Fast facts

- 26 hospitals across 13 CBSAs — most dispersed state TEAM roster in the country
- Pittsburgh and Philadelphia CBSAs NOT selected — UPMC’s TEAM exposure is through secondary markets
- Harrisburg–Carlisle: 5 hospitals (UPMC and Penn State Health) — largest PA market
- ~2.9 million Medicare beneficiaries — 22.4% of population (above national average)
- 51.0% HRRP penalty rate (vs. 48.1% national average)
- Major systems: UPMC, Penn State Health, Geisinger Health, Lehigh Valley Health Network, St. Luke’s Health Network, Trinity Health

Complete hospital directory by CBSA

CBSA	Hospitals	Named hospitals
Harrisburg–Carlisle, PA	5	UPMC Pinnacle Hospitals · UPMC Carlisle · Penn State Health Holy Spirit Medical Center · Penn State Health Hampden Medical Center · Milton S. Hershey Medical Center (Penn State Health)
Hermitage, PA	4	UPMC Horizon · Sharon Regional Medical Center · Grove City Hospital · Edgewood Surgical Hospital

CBSA	Hospitals	Named hospitals
Erie, PA	3	UPMC Hamot · Saint Vincent Hospital (Trinity Health) · LECOM Medical Center
Pottsville, PA	3	Lehigh Valley Hospital–Schuylkill · St. Luke’s Miners Memorial Hospital · Geisinger St. Luke’s Hospital
Reading, PA	3	Reading Hospital (Tower Health) · Penn State Health St. Joseph · Surgical Institute of Reading
Sunbury, PA	1	Geisinger Medical Center
Pittsburgh, PA	1	Uniontown Hospital (Acuity Healthcare)
Lewistown, PA	1	Geisinger–Lewistown Hospital
DuBois, PA	1	Penn Highlands DuBois
Oil City, PA	1	UPMC Northwest
Meadville, PA	1	Meadville Medical Center
Warren, PA	1	Warren General Hospital
Indiana, PA	1	Indiana Regional Medical Center

(Source: Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (2026). TEAM participant list.)

UPMC in Pennsylvania’s TEAM markets

UPMC — the Pittsburgh–headquartered \$26 billion health system that is Pennsylvania’s largest employer and one of the largest nonprofit health systems in the world — participates in TEAM through its regional hospitals rather than its Pittsburgh flagship. UPMC Pinnacle Hospitals and UPMC Carlisle anchor the Harrisburg market; UPMC Horizon (Farrell/Shenango Valley) and the western Pennsylvania hospitals (UPMC Northwest in Oil City) represent the system’s smaller market presence.

This creates an interesting analytical scenario: UPMC’s TEAM performance will be measured at hospitals that are not its primary institutional identity. UPMC Pinnacle is a large system in its own right (multiple hospitals in south–central Pennsylvania), but it operates in a market context very different from UPMC’s Pittsburgh academic medical center environment. The system’s post–acute network in the Harrisburg market — developed through Pinnacle’s independent history before the UPMC merger — will be the key operational variable for TEAM episode management.

Penn State Health, Geisinger, and the academic–integrated system landscape

Penn State Health occupies the most prominent academic medicine position in Pennsylvania’s TEAM cohort. **Milton S. Hershey Medical Center** — the Penn State College of Medicine’s teaching hospital and the region’s Level I trauma center — is TEAM’s Pennsylvania academic anchor, performing high volumes of the TEAM procedure types. Penn State Health Holy Spirit and Penn State Health Hampden Medical Center complete the system’s Harrisburg market presence.

Geisinger Health — the integrated health system renowned in health policy circles for its ProvenCare quality program and its insurance arm, Geisinger Health Plan — participates in TEAM through **Geisinger**



Medical Center (Sunbury), **Geisinger St. Luke's Hospital** (Orwigsburg, in the Pottsville market), and **Geisinger-Lewistown Hospital** (Lewistown). Geisinger's ProvenCare program — which guarantees surgical outcomes for certain elective procedures — is precisely the type of care pathway standardization that TEAM's bundled payment structure incentivizes. Geisinger's TEAM performance will be closely watched as a benchmark for what integrated delivery system innovation can achieve under mandatory episode accountability.

The **Lehigh Valley Health Network** (Lehigh Valley Hospital–Schuylkill in the Pottsville market) and **St. Luke's Health Network** (St. Luke's Miners Memorial Hospital in Pottsville) round out the central Pennsylvania market. Both systems have their primary hospitals in the Allentown–Bethlehem–Easton metro, which was not selected as a TEAM CBSA — meaning they participate in TEAM through secondary market affiliates rather than their flagship facilities.

Rural Pennsylvania and the dispersed TEAM challenge

Pennsylvania's 13-CBSA distribution reflects the state's economic geography: a historic industrial economy that created dozens of mid-sized cities (Reading, Pottsville, Oil City, Warren, Indiana, DuBois, Meadville) each anchored by a community hospital serving a surrounding rural catchment area. These hospitals — **Reading Hospital** (Tower Health), **Warren General Hospital**, **Meadville Medical Center**, **Indiana Regional Medical Center**, **Penn Highlands DuBois** — operate in post-acute markets with limited SNF capacity, aging populations with complex comorbidities, and constrained care management resources.

Pennsylvania's **51.0% HRRP penalty rate** — above the national average — is consistent with the demographic and structural challenges of these smaller-city markets. Under TEAM, the hospitals most at risk of exceeding target prices are precisely those in lower-resource markets where post-discharge coordination infrastructure is hardest to build and where social determinants of health create readmission risk that exceeds what any clinical protocol can fully prevent.

Frequently asked questions

How many Pennsylvania hospitals are mandated for CMS TEAM?

26 hospitals across 13 CBSAs. Harrisburg leads with 5.

Is UPMC in Pittsburgh required to participate in CMS TEAM?

The Pittsburgh CBSA was not selected. UPMC participates in TEAM through its secondary market hospitals: UPMC Pinnacle (Harrisburg), UPMC Carlisle, UPMC Horizon (Hermitage), and UPMC Northwest (Oil City).

Is the Philadelphia area in CMS TEAM?

No. The Philadelphia–Camden–Wilmington CBSA was not selected for CMS TEAM. Penn Medicine, Jefferson Health, and Main Line Health flagship hospitals are not on the TEAM roster.

Is Geisinger Health in CMS TEAM?

Yes. Geisinger participates through Geisinger Medical Center (Sunbury), Geisinger St. Luke's Hospital (Pottsville market), and Geisinger-Lewistown Hospital.

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Named hospitals (live roster)

Table 3

state	hospitals	Named hospitals
PA Harrisburg–Carlisle	5	PENN STATE HEALTH HOLY SPIRIT MEDICAL CENTER · UPMC CARLISLE · UPMC PINNACLE HOSPITALS · MILTON S HERSHEY MEDICAL CENTER · PENN STATE HEALTH HAMPDEN MEDICAL CENTER
PA Hermitage	4	UPMC HORIZON · SHARON REGIONAL MEDICAL CENTER · GROVE CITY HOSPITAL · EDGEWOOD SURGICAL HOSPITAL
PA Erie	3	SAINT VINCENT HOSPITAL · UPMC HAMOT · LECOM MEDICAL CENTER AND BEHAVIORAL HEALTH PAV
PA Pottsville	3	LEHIGH VALLEY HOSPITAL–SCHUYLKILL · ST LUKE’S MINERS MEMORIAL HOSPITAL · GEISINGER ST. LUKE’S HOSPITAL
PA Reading	3	READING HOSPITAL · PENN STATE HEALTH ST. JOSEPH · SURGICAL INSTITUTE OF READING
PA DuBois	1	PENN HIGHLANDS DUBOIS
PA Indiana	1	INDIANA REGIONAL MEDICAL CENTER
PA Lewis–town	1	GEISINGER–LEWISTOWN HOSPITAL
PA Meadville	1	MEADVILLE MEDICAL CENTER
PA Oil City	1	UPMC NORTHWEST
PA Pitts–burgh	1	UNIONTOWN HOSPITAL
PA Sun–bury	1	GEISINGER MEDICAL CENTER
PA Warren	1	WARREN GENERAL HOSPITAL



Disclaimer. Draft for internal briefing. Counts follow the vendored CMS participant file. Not legal, financial, regulatory, or clinical advice.

